

Go to another frame, say frame **12** and move the ball on or near the ground and set another key frame. What we are doing here is setting up where the ball is going to hit and bounce. Scrub through the time-line to see the ball movements. Once you're satisfied with that, go to another frame and move the ball up in the air again to follow the motion and press **[S]**. Follow these steps until you are satisfied with the bouncing look. Now that we have set-up the ball animation, refine it by going to Graph Editor located under **Windows > Animation Editor > Graph Editor**.

The Graph Editor contains tools and operations for manipulating animation curves and keys within the graph view of the Graph Editor.

When you select an object, you will see your object **NURBSphere1** on the left side of the editor, along with the animated values of the Translation and Rotation of the X, Y and Z curve. Select **Translate Y** from the left-hand side and you will see only that line or curve. When you select the curve, it will turn white (the default curve selection colour). Now try and select a single point, you will see a tangent connected to it. Select one of the two handles. Notice that the handle that is selected turns yellow. If you move the handle, you are also changing the animation values. Keep the Graph Editor open on one side and view the ball in one of the viewports.

You will need to select the points, break the tangents and manipulate it accordingly. Follow the videos titled **AnimationPart1** and **2** on this month's DVD.

Once you are done with the graph editor, save your file and view the animation. Next, add an animated feel to the ball by adding some rotation and squash effect.

## Rotation and squash

Since the ball looks static when it's bouncing, let's give an exaggerated feel to it. The best way to animate is always via the graph editor. Always play your animation to get an idea how it looking and what kind of movements would make it look better.

To rotate the ball, go to the frame where the ball is bouncing on the ground, in our case it's frame **12**, zoom in and press **[E]** or select the rotate tool. Rotate it ever so slightly to get the movement right. Look at references of a bouncing ball to get the desired

